

Patient: **SAMPLE**
PATIENT

DOB:

Sex:

MRN:

1001 IgG Food Antibodies Profile - Serum

Methodology: EIA and Chemiluminescent

IgG Food Antibody Results												
Dairy			Vegetables			Fish/Shellfish			Nuts and Grains			
Casein	VL		Alfalfa	0		Clam	0		Almond	VL		
Cheddar cheese	VL		Asparagus	VL		Cod	0		Buckwheat	VL		
Cottage cheese	VL		Avocado	0		Crab	0		Corn	0		
Cow's milk	1+		Beets	0		Lobster	0		Corn gluten	1+		
Goat's milk	0		Broccoli	VL		Oyster	0		Gluten	3+		
Lactalbumin	VL		Cabbage	0		Red snapper	0		Kidney bean	VL		
Yogurt	1+		Carrot	0		Salmon	0		Lentil	0		
Fruits			Celery	0		Sardine	0		Lima bean	0		
Apple	0		Cucumber	0		Shrimp	0		Oat	0		
Apricot	0		Garlic	1+		Sole	0		Peanut	0		
Banana	0		Green Pepper	0		Trout	0		Pecan	0		
Blueberry	0		Lettuce	0		Tuna	0		Pinto bean	0		
Cranberry	0		Mushroom	0		Poultry/Meats			Rice	VL		
Grape	VL		Olive	0		Beef	0		Rye	0		
Grapefruit	0		Onion	0		Chicken	0		Sesame	3+		
Lemon	0		Pea	0		Egg white	0		Soy	VL		
Orange	0		Potato, sweet	0		Egg yolk	0		Sunflower seed	3+		
Papaya	0		Potato, white	VL		Lamb	0		Walnut	VL		
Peach	VL		Spinach	VL		Pork	0		Wheat	3+		
Pear	0		String bean	VL		Turkey	0		Miscellaneous			
Pineapple	1+		Tomato	VL								
Plum	0		Zucchini	0								
Raspberry	0		Total IgE							Yeast	VL	
Strawberry	0									Cane sugar	VL	
										Chocolate	VL	
										Coffee	3+	

Summary of IgG Test Results

Reactive / Non-Reactive Foods

3+ High

Coffee	Gluten	Sesame	Sunflower seed
Wheat			

1+ Low

Corn gluten	Cow's milk	Garlic	Pineapple
Yogurt			

VL Very Low

Almond	Asparagus	Broccoli	Buckwheat
Cane sugar	Casein	Cheddar cheese	Chocolate
Cottage cheese	Grape	Kidney bean	Lactalbumin
Peach	Potato, white	Rice	Soy
Spinach	String bean	Tomato	Walnut
Yeast			

0 None Detected

Alfalfa	Apple	Apricot	Avocado
Banana	Beef	Beets	Blueberry
Cabbage	Carrot	Celery	Chicken
Clam	Cod	Corn	Crab
Cranberry	Cucumber	Egg white	Egg yolk
Goat's milk	Grapefruit	Green pepper	Lamb
Lemon	Lentil	Lettuce	Lima bean
Lobster	Mushroom	Oat	Olive
Onion	Orange	Oyster	Papaya
Pea	Peanut	Pear	Pecan
Pinto bean	Plum	Pork	Potato, sweet
Raspberry	Red Snapper	Rye	Salmon
Sardine	Shrimp	Sole	Strawberry
Trout	Tuna	Turkey	Zucchini



Commentary

Overview

Immunoglobulin G (IgG) antibodies that elicit an immune response to food are in a class distinct from Immunoglobulin E (IgE) food allergy reactions. IgG-mediated food responses are described as delayed hypersensitivity reactions and have been associated in the peer-reviewed literature with an array of common clinical conditions including migraine, obesity, asthma, autoimmune diseases, and irritable bowel syndrome.

IgG Testing: Factors to Consider

IgG testing can be very useful in screening foods that a person is eating on a regular basis and which may be causing adverse reactions. However, it is possible to have adverse reactions to foods with low or non-detected levels of IgG. Because the IgG profile measures exposure of the immune system to food antigens, performing this test on a patient who is not consuming a particular food or who is taking a drug with known ability to suppress immune function (i.e. steroids) may result in the test not showing a positive reaction, potentially leading to a false negative result for the particular food. Be advised that if the patient is already on an elimination diet due to known food reactions, a negative result on an IgG food antibody profile does not necessarily mean that they can freely eat the food without experiencing symptoms.

IgG Results Interpretation

The amount of IgG antibodies is measured using a semi-quantitative ELISA assay procedure. The relative degrees of IgG present for each food are reported using a semi-quantitative level; None Detected (0), VL (very low), Low (1+), Moderate (2+) or High (3+). The degree of reactivity may not correlate with the severity of patient's response, therefore clinical correlation is advised as it can help direct treatment.

Clinical Management of Reactive IgG Foods: Elimination Diet

The purpose of an elimination diet is to pinpoint symptom-triggering foods that may be the root cause of and/or perpetuating chronic health issues. This diet is specific to food sensitivities that elicit an Immunoglobulin G (IgG) response and not those defined as classic (IgE-mediated) food allergy reactions. An elimination diet is a strategic process which depends on the oversight of the healthcare provider to ensure that a patient's nutritional requirements - macronutrient, micronutrient, and caloric needs - are adequate.

Four-Phases of an Elimination Diet



PHASE 1 – PREPARATION

A patient's clinical presentation and the IgG Food Antibody Assessment results typically determine which food(s) to temporarily remove from the diet. The average time frame for an elimination diet is 1 to 3 months. It is optimal to work with the patient to determine a start and end date for the elimination diet. Patient guidance around preparation ahead of the start date is important to ensure success. These include: (1) encouraging the patient to remove offending foods from the home and adjust grocery shopping accordingly; (2) providing the patient with resources that advance meal preparation, such as recipe books or reputable websites. Directing the patient to record foods consumed, date of consumption/elimination, and any notable changes in symptoms in a food journal can help track the progress of the diet.



Commentary



PHASE 2 – ELIMINATION

It is important to ensure the patient avoids those foods which resulted in a demonstrable reaction, either in whole food forms or as ingredients in other prepared foods to gain the greatest benefit. For patients unable to eliminate all reactive foods from their diet, focusing on the foods that elicited a stronger reaction (i.e.: 2+ and 3+) may be considered for an elimination diet. Practitioners may also encourage elimination of a complete food group when the patient shows reactivity to all foods tested within that group.



PHASE 3 – REINTRODUCTION

The reintroduction of eliminated foods is done one food at a time while monitoring for any adverse reaction. The patient should consume the test food several times throughout the day for several days. If symptoms occur with reintroduction, the patient should be instructed to remove that food once again and to evaluate whether the symptoms diminish over the next few days following elimination. Signs which may indicate an IgG food reaction include the following: headache, itching, bloating, fatigue, diarrhea or constipation, and indigestion. If the food does not cause symptoms during the reintroduction phase, it can be added back into the diet. The patient should continue this process with each food eliminated.

CAUTION: All patients warrant counseling related to signs and management of immediate hypersensitivity reactions prior to food reintroduction following an elimination diet. If reintroduction of a food causes an immediate allergic reaction (i.e. swelling of face, mouth, tongue, etc.; wheezing, rash/hives, or other allergic symptoms), it is imperative that the patient be treated as soon as possible. Following resolution of the immediate hypersensitivity reaction, the patient should be instructed to completely avoid consumption of that food.



PHASE 4 – LONG TERM MANAGEMENT

An elimination diet based on food sensitivity testing is part of a comprehensive approach to overall gastrointestinal health. Based on the test results and the complete clinical presentation of the patient, a long-term plan is usually developed utilizing the results of the reintroduction phase. Clinicians may also consider assessing and treating intestinal permeability, as gut barrier integrity is important for proper immune responses to foods. Nutrients that have been found to support intestinal barrier and decrease potential inflammation are glutamine, vitamin A, vitamin D, essential fatty acids (Omega-3), probiotics, and butyrate. Botanicals that can also be considered to assist with intestinal health are slippery elm, deglycyrrhizinated licorice (DGL), Aloe vera extract, and marshmallow root.

For additional information on the elimination diet and how to better understand your results, please download the "Elimination Diet Handout" from our website at <https://www.gdx.net/elimination-diet-handout.pdf>.